

# What are Opinions? Integrating Theory and Methods for Automatically Analyzing Opinionated Communication (OPINION)

## MINUTES OF THE JOINT WORKING GROUP MEETING II.2

COST ACTION CA21129 OPINION, 11-12 June 2024, U of Salamanca

Compiled by Christian Baden, Carlos Cunha, Johannes B. Gruber, Damian Trilling,  
Hajo Boomgaarden and Mariken van der Velden

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### ACTION Status

- CSO approval: 27/05/2022
- Start date: 22/09/2022

## 1 ATTENDANCE

### WG Members:

Kinga Adamczewska (PL), Carlos Arcila Calderón (ES), Anna Baczkowska (PL), Christian Baden (IL), Snezana Bajceta (RS), Malgorzata Bielenia (PL), Magdalena Bielenia-Grajewska (PL), David Herrero-Blanco (NL), Ljubisa Bojic (RS), Nicoleta Corbu (RO), Anita Ciunova-Shuleska (MK), Bruno Costa (PT), Alona Dolinsky (NL), Emese Domahidi (DE), Jelena Gledic (RS), Roksana Gloc (PL), Johannes B. Gruber (NL), Edlira Gugu (AL), Dana Guy (IE), Valerie Hase (DE), Alba Haveriku (AL), Agnieszka Hess (PL), Ana Jovancevic (IE), Ledia Kazazi (AL), Nelda Kote (AL), Ema Kristo (AL), Aleksandra Krstic (RS), Tamara Kunić (HR), Ana Langer (UK), Barbara Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk (PL), Artur Lipinski (PL), Michaela Maier (DE), Jaromir Mazak (CZ), Dimitra Milioni (CY), Ana Milojevic (RS), Larisa Mistrean (MD), Anela Mulahmetović Ibrišimović (BH), Elena Negrea Busuioc (RO), Alper Ozcan (TR), Nikolina Palamidovska-Sterjadovska (MK), Nenad Pandelic (RS), Ardita Reci (AL), Jana Rosenfeldova (CZ), Jose Santana Pereira (PT), Serhei Sprincean (MD), Nina Springer (DE), Agnieszka Stepinska (PL), Aleksandar Tomasevic (RS), Damian Trilling (NL), Aleksandra Urman (CH), Mariken van der Velden (NL), Selma Veseljevic Jerkovic (BH), Srdjan Vesic (FR), Lenka Vochocova (CZ), Vuk Vukovic (ME), Bruno Yun (UK), Nuran Öksüz (TR), Sule Yüksel Özmen (TR)

### 21 COST countries represented:

Albania, Bosnia and Hercegovina, Croatia, Cyprus, Czechia, France, Germany, Ireland, Israel, Moldova, Montenegro, Netherlands, North Macedonia, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Serbia, Spain, Switzerland, UK, Türkiye.

...as well as several Hybrid Participants

- Advance glossary and literature reviews, develop book project (WG1)
- Advance tools and data inventories, formulate research agendas (WG2/3)
- Develop training materials and plans for further training events (WG4)
- Ensure the coordination of activities across WGs, subgroups and project groups

### 3 AGENDA

#### ***Tuesday, 11 June 2024***

**09:00-09:30** *Arrival & Coffee*

#### **09:30-10:00 Welcome Plenary**

Room: Adolfo Suarez Events Hall

- **Welcome** - *Christian Baden, Carlos Arcila Calderón*
- **Introduction of Project Space & Workshop Sessions** - *hosts*
- **Practical issues** - *Carlos Arcila Calderón*

#### **10:00-12:30 Working Group Sessions I (parallel sessions)**

| <b>Theory</b>                          | <b>Tools</b>                            | <b>Data &amp; Application</b>            | <b>Dissemination &amp; Inclusion</b>           |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Room 003A                              | Room 003B                               | Room 004                                 | Room 005                                       |
| <i>Chair:</i><br><i>Nicoleta Corbu</i> | <i>Chair:</i><br><i>Damian Trilling</i> | <i>Chair:</i><br><i>Hajo Boomgaarden</i> | <i>Chair:</i><br><i>Carlos Arcila Calderon</i> |

**12:30-13:30** *Lunch at the Café-Restaurant of the Faculty of Law*

#### **13:30-15:30 Project Space & Workshops (parallel sessions)**

Any initiatives beyond the listed sessions will be able to meet in an additional open space.

| <b>"Team 5"</b>                                                | <b>Computational Literacy</b>                                                                      | <b>Measuring LLMs' "opinions"</b>                                           | <b>Hackathon Planning Meeting</b>      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Room 003A                                                      | Room 003B                                                                                          | Room 004                                                                    | Room 005                               |
| <i>Host:</i><br><i>Aleksandra Krstic &amp; Dimitra Milioni</i> | <i>Hosts:</i><br><i>Ema Kristo, Edlira Gugu, David Herrero Blanco &amp; Carlos Arcila Calderón</i> | <i>Host:</i><br><i>Aleksandra Urman, Johannes Gruber &amp; Valerie Hase</i> | <i>Host:</i><br><i>Christian Baden</i> |

**15:30-16:00** *Break / Time for Projects*

#### **16:00-18:00 Working Group Sessions II (parallel sessions)**

| <b>Theory</b>                               | <b>Tools</b>                            | <b>Data &amp; Application</b>            | <b>Dissemination &amp; Inclusion</b>           |
|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Room 003A                                   | Room 003B                               | Room 004                                 | Room 005                                       |
| <i>Chair:</i><br><i>Agnieszka Stepinska</i> | <i>Chair:</i><br><i>Damian Trilling</i> | <i>Chair:</i><br><i>Hajo Boomgaarden</i> | <i>Chair:</i><br><i>Carlos Arcila Calderon</i> |

**18:15** *City Walking Tour (voluntary)*

#### **Afterwards Working Group Dinner (voluntary, self-paid)**

| <b>Theory</b>        | <b>Tools</b>            | <b>Data &amp; Application</b> | <b>Dissemination &amp; Inclusion</b> |
|----------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Salam Placentinos 10 | Corte y Cata Serranos 1 | Don Quijote Serranos 28       | Corte y Cata Serranos 1              |

## Wednesday, 12 June 2024

09:00-09:15 *Coffee*

09:15-12:00 **Working Group Sessions III** (*parallel sessions*)

| Theory                        | Tools                     | Data & Application         | Dissemination & Inclusion        |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Room 003A                     | Room 003B                 | Room 004                   | Room 005                         |
| Chair:<br>Agnieszka Stepinska | Chair:<br>Damian Trilling | Chair:<br>Hajo Boomgaarden | Chair:<br>Carlos Arcila Calderon |

12:00-13:00 *Lunch at the Café-Restaurant of the Faculty of Law*

13:00-14:30 **Masterclass: (stream)** <https://usal-es.zoom.us/j/84629480260>

Room: Adolfo Suarez Events Hall

**The Good, The Bad, and The Generated: Opinion Mining with (local) AI**  
Johannes B. Gruber, VU Amsterdam

14:30-16:00 **Project Space & Workshops** (*parallel sessions*)

Any initiatives beyond the listed sessions will be able to meet in an additional open space.

| Theorizing Public Opinion | LLMs as a Tool for Text Analysis                                                    | Linguistics Group                       | Public Opinion in a Digital World                                    |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Room 003A                 | Room 003B                                                                           | Room 004                                | Room 005                                                             |
| Host:<br>Christian Baden  | Host:<br>Ljubisa Bojic, Anela Mulahmetovic, Ibrisimovic & Selma Veseljevic Jerkovic | Host:<br>Barbara Lewandowska Tomaszczyk | Host:<br>Agnieszka Hess, Elena Negrea Busuioc, & Agnieszka Stepinska |

16:00-16:30 *Coffee*

16:30-17:30 **Closing Plenary & Wrap-up** (stream) <https://usal-es.zoom.us/j/89072936168>

Room: Adolfo Suarez Events Hall

- **Reports & Updates** - *Working Group Chairs*
- **Expanding the OPINION Universe** - *Christian Baden*

17:30-18:30 **Management Committee Meeting** (*hybrid*)

Room: Adolfo Suarez Events Hall

- The Agenda for this meeting will be emailed directly to all members of the OPINION Management Committee.

## 4 OPENING PLENARY SESSION

*Christian Baden, Chair*

- The network has at this point more than 200 members from 40 countries, roughly half of these from Inclusion Target Countries. We still lack representation in Iceland, Bulgaria, Georgia, and Slovakia.
- The WGs have completed their first round of Deliverables: WG1 has created a glossary of key terms, and a literature review of existing theory on opinions; WG2 has created an inventory of tools and works using these tools, and WG3 has created an inventory of data sources and applications; and WG4 has created the COpA Training School, to be held for the first time in Salamanca following this meeting.
- There are lots of collaborative projects that have grown out of the existing networks, which contribute to OPINION's mission and will be given space within WG Meeting programs to foster further collaboration and joint research.
- The main challenge at this point is to make sure that the various outcomes of the WG process, as well as the collaborative projects, feed back into the network and advance our joint work. Please make sure to address the community in what you create, and contribute to the sharing of knowledge and resources within the network.
- STSM and ITC Conference Grants are available to support such work.

*Quick introductions of the Project Collaboration Spaces in the Program*

- Team 5  
*Aleksandra Krstic & Dimitra Milioni*
- Computational Literacy  
*Ema Kristo, Edlira Gugu, David Herrero Blanco, & Carlos Arcila Calderon*
- Measuring "Opinions" of Generative LLMs with Associative Tasks  
*Aleksandra Urman, Johannes B. Gruber, & Valerie Hase*
- OPINION Hackathon Ljubljana Planning Meeting  
*Christian Baden*
- Theorizing Public Opinion in Digital Media  
*Christian Baden*
- Research Workshop: Evaluation of LLMs as a Tool for Text Analysis  
*Ljubisa Bojic, Anela Mulahmetovic Ibrisimovic, & Selma Veseljevic Jerkovic*
- Linguistics Group  
*Barbara Lewandowska Tomaszczyk*
- How to Study Public Opinion in a Digitalized World  
*Agnieszka Hess, Elena Negrea Busuioc, & Agnieszka Stepinska*

**A word from our Host**

*Carlos Arcila Calderon, Local Host*

## 5 WG SESSIONS: WG1 THEORY

### **Schedule:**

Tuesday 11 June, 9:30-12:00 Session I  
Update on sub-groups activities, research projects, papers, and future initiatives  
Tuesday 11 June, 15:30-18 Session II  
Literature review & glossary  
Wednesday 12 June, 9:00-12:00 Session III  
Edited book and manifesto

### **Session I**

**Update on sub-groups activities, research projects, papers, & future initiatives**  
(chair: Nicoleta Corbu)

Update on sub-groups' activities

(1) Lenka presented the Political Communication and Cultural Studies subgroup: Reports on Lit review and Glossary; two work-in-progress papers: functionality and citizens' moral emotional evaluations on televised political debates (see presentation attached); STSM and the mobilities

(2) Ania presented the Communication Studies subgroup: Reports on Lit review and Glossary; Work-in-progress for 24 papers (to be published as journal articles or chapters in three edited books (see ppt presentation attached); Workshops on annotation for the project on Reddit messages

(3) Barbara presented the Linguistics subgroup's research projects and activities (see presentation attached):

- Linguistic approaches to opinions: theory, semantics and pragmatics (project I)
- Computational approaches to opinion: AI and LLMs (project II)
- Misgendering (project III)
- Opinion dynamics and opinion change (project IV)
- Entitled Opinions in Conflict - Victimhood discourses (project V)
- Literature review (VI)
- Glossary (VII)
- Special Issue I. (VIII), Special Issue II. (IX) Other papers (X)

(4) Christian presented the Public Opinion book: Reports on Lit review and Glossary; Work-in-progress for a theoretical piece on redefining "public opinion" in the high choice media environment.

Presentation for the current projects:

(1) Aleksandra presented the Team5 project on MEPs discourse - already 25 people involved; data gathering still in the making; the group met in Amsterdam and revised their strategy

(2) Elena presented the project "How to study public opinion in a digitalized world" - lead by Agnieszka Hess, Agnieszka Stepinska and Elena Negrea-Busuioc - currently 7 partners, still looking for others: in-depth interviews

(3) Christian, Barbara and Ania had already presented their projects (several) during the subgroup presentation (see ppts).

Other topics:

- A short introduction of the new members + info about emails, slack channels

- Further activities:

Christian discussed the ECREA COST panel in Ljubljana;  
Christian announced the possibility of publishing in the journal of the  
Weizenbaum Institute, Journal of Digital Society (see here: <https://ojs.weizenbaum-institut.de/index.php/wjds>);  
Aleksandra announced a new conference (deadline July - see emails from Carlos  
and slack channel “market” (see here: <http://www.upns.rs/en>);  
Elena announced the ongoing call for the Romanian Journal of Communication and  
Public Relations (see here:  
<https://journalofcommunication.ro/index.php/journalofcommunication>)

## Session II

## Literature review & glossary

(chair: Agnieszka Stępińska)

Two WG1 deliverables ready in 18 months (April 2024): Literature review and glossary - more than 30 scholars from 13 countries working together on these two tasks.

Two more deliverables: manifesto (month 36) and book (month 48)

(1) Literature review: file spread in May around COST Action OPINION members

## TABLE OF CONTENT

## Part I: Linguistics

1. Definitions of opinion
2. Models: key elements
3. Linguistic expression of opinion
4. Opinion research and measurement methodology
5. Effects
6. Final comments

## Part II: Opinion in Public Opinion Theory and Research

1. Definitions of (public) opinion
2. Models: key elements
3. Types and typologies
4. How are opinions formed?
5. Expressions of opinions
6. Methods used to investigate and measure opinions

### Part III: Political Communication and Culture Studies

1. Definitions of opinion
2. Theoretical implications of the study of opinion
3. Models: key elements
4. Qualitative and quantitative methods
5. Conclusions

## Part IV: Opinions in Communication and Media Studies

1. Definitions of opinion
2. Theoretical foundations
3. Models
4. Methods of expressing opinions
5. Conclusions



#### Next steps:

- Review and update of the working papers
- Edition: references, APA style 7th edition
- Book chapters – structure and content

#### (2) Glossary

Outcome of the sub-groups - different perspectives – interdisciplinary project: 172 entries on the list; Alphabetical order of the entries; Authorship of each entry.

#### Challenges:

- Some entries need to be either deleted or developed.
- Some entries are doubled – to be combined?
- Some entries are similar – how to link them?
- Cross-discipline entries (e.g. discourse; framing, hate speech)
- Cross-references between entries

#### Solutions to the challenges – next steps:

(1) Reviews of entries (at least one review per entry); collaboration; contribution; co-authorship

We will circulate a list of all entries, inviting WG1 members to contribute to that task by:

- Adding a new entry (with a description),
- Expanding already existing but underdeveloped entry,
- Revising an existing entry in collaboration with the author of a previous version of the entry.

(2) Checking all duplicated entries and making a decision on how to integrate them.

(3) Checking all overlapping entries and changing a structure of the glossary into a multi-level one, if necessary.

Below please find steps we are going to take to complete the GLOSSARY:

STEP 1: Contacting people who suggested entries that have not been developed so far, asking them to either continue their work on the entries or decide to drop them.

STEP 2: Inviting all WG1 members to select entries that have been suggested by other people but not developed by them and then eventually dropped by them. In that case, we could keep some of these entries and those who are interested in working on them can deliver the descriptions (deadline: end of September 2024).

STEP 3: Contacting authors of duplicated entries or overlapping entries, asking them to decide whether they would like to integrate them or keep separate due to different approaches/disciplines (deadline: end of September 2024).

STEP 4: Once a list is completed, we will ask all WG1 participants to review entries (at least 2 entries per person, based on the field of expertise). We will distribute a link to a file where all WG1 members could describe their fields of expertise. Please provide up to three fields so we can distribute tasks later this year (Fall 2024) The deadline for delivering the reviews: mid-December. The guidelines will be provided in September.

The complete Glossary will be available in the Open Access repositories (CC-BY license; DOI) and at the website of the COST Action.

### **Session III**

#### **Edited book and manifesto**

(chair: Agnieszka Stępińska)

##### **(1) Book:**

In Salamanca, we established the editorial team: Agnieszka Stępińska, Carlos Cunha, Gabriella Szabo, Aleksandra Krstic, and Anna Bączkowska.

Please take a look at a CALL FOR BOOK CHAPTERS attached. This is just a draft. The editorial team will have an online meeting to discuss details soon. We will send you a separate message with more details in a couple of weeks.

We still need to decide on: (a) a title – please share your ideas; (b) a publisher (e.g. Routledge, Sage, Oxford University Press, Palgrave Macmillan, etc. – can you think of any book series to be considered? They should offer an option of the open access. If you have any ideas on the title or/and a publisher, please contact Agnieszka Stępińska.

##### **(2) Manifesto:**

A collection of recommendations for: (a) scholars (research agenda; advancing the research; interdisciplinary approach, validation, measures, etc.), (b) stakeholders, including journalists, politicians, business (opinion polls and other types of practitioners).

- A separate document (DOI, open access; website; repositories)
- Final part of the book (recommendations)

Example: <https://drops.dagstuhl.de/entities/document/10.4230/DagMan.9.1.43>

We will collect the ideas and we will work on this during next WG1 meeting.

#### **OTHER WG1 BUSINESS:**

(1) Nicoleta Corbu stepped down from a position of WG1 vice-chair due to her new professional obligations. Thank you Nicoleta for your work! Nicoleta stays with WG1 as a ‘regular’ participant.

(2) Gabriella Szabo, one of the sub-group leaders (Political communication) agreed to take a position of the WG1 vice-chair. In a separate message you will get a link to a survey – please vote. Elections of the vice-chairs is up to the WG. All participants of the Salamanca meeting voted in favor of this candidate but we would like to provide an opportunity for everyone to participate in the elections process.

(3) Next meetings (to be decided)

## 6 WG SESSIONS: WG2 TOOLS (partly joint with WG3 DATA & APPLICATIONS)

Over the three WG-sessions, WG2 primarily worked on the following five issues:

**Retrieval of full papers** <https://github.com/JBGruber/opinion-wg2/issues/11>

The papers selected in #9 need to be downloaded and stored somewhere so the coders can access them when they are assigned an item.

Johannes B Gruber:

This spreadsheet contains all abstracts, and I added column whether I've already downloaded the corresponding PDF:

[https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/14gsrQyw\\_QNamph74kAhy8lw2QB2PtY11KpoAWGFUcUM/edit?usp=sharing](https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/14gsrQyw_QNamph74kAhy8lw2QB2PtY11KpoAWGFUcUM/edit?usp=sharing)

1040 are done, I couldn't get 4212. Out of these, 3455 have a doi, so I would focus on these first. I'm not sure if there is a reliable search engine for the others, other than WoS and Scopus (where we got the data from, so no point in looking there for the dois again).

A couple of thoughts:

- it might be worthwhile to check from which publishers the missing articles come. Maybe there is a good way to get the files for annotation for a couple of them. And if a majority of PDFs come from these publishers, we could be done relatively quickly.
- this might be a good opportunity to test out <https://github.com/lavague-ai/LaVague> or another "ai" scraping tool.

Aleksandra Urman:

To be done by using Zotero, possibly splitting the task between several people (required skills: Zotero and basic R usage). Sasha will ask on slack who would want to join, we split the task, try to be done with this in the first week of July.

**Reading & summarizing overview papers** <https://github.com/JBGruber/opinion-wg2/issues/15>

Through #9, we also identify other review articles. We should probably not simply include them in #14, but look at them separately. This should be done at least simultaneously, or even better before #14, so we can identify leanings for our own task.

Valerie Hase:

This task has been buried a bit, so we haven't really talked much about it yet. Essentially, we need a plan of attack for the 27 papers that contain a literature review already. We identified those in the abstract annotation and there might be older work that we haven't identified yet.

This would go into the related work section of the paper.

Here is the list of papers we have identified so far:

<https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1qaw8VIDJh0QB5iKLVWL0Ktr8hfBecBfYnAFGI2f2cOY/edit>

Next steps:

- Mark N = 27 studies as relevant vs. irrelevant
- Do for remaining papers Damian will identify as relevant based on full corpus
- Add forward-/backward check (references in papers, google scholar, etc.)
- Inform Johannes about measurements/variables drawn from lit review
- Write theory section

**Annotating papers with generative LLMs** <https://github.com/JBGruber/opinion-wg2/issues/20>

This has yielded excellent results in our coding in Limassol, where we did this with ChatGPT. Essentially, we simply ask a model to answer the questions we ask coders (outlined here). ChatGPT has a way to handle PDFs on the web interface (maybe also on the API). Ideally, we would try to do this with an open source model like llama3 (open-webui also supports PDF uploads, not sure how they handle it). But given the length of papers and the fact that we might not be too concerned with reproducibility in this case, GPT-4o might make most sense.

Johannes B. Gruber:

I think we essentially just need a RAG system. I've started a Quarto notebook here:

<https://github.com/JBGruber/opinion-wg2/blob/gllm-annotation/paper-annotation-gllm/llm-annotation.qmd>

The notebook contains code that downloads the validation data already. I think it's unlikely we can validate this automatically. Probably it makes more sense to check manually whether each answer is correct or not and note it down. (obviously we need to set a seed to reproduce the answers)

You can find the Codebook here:

[https://docs.google.com/document/d/185Q1luJ0ebJfEb1BepMxkbzt23XrYX\\_OOICUGqrKdbw/edit#heading=h.hkgzwghr5jje](https://docs.google.com/document/d/185Q1luJ0ebJfEb1BepMxkbzt23XrYX_OOICUGqrKdbw/edit#heading=h.hkgzwghr5jje)

Or in this Notebook that set up the task (it also contains the variable names in the annotated data): [https://github.com/JBGruber/opinion-wg2/blob/gllm-annotation/paper-annotation/3\\_wg2\\_full\\_paper\\_annotation.qmd](https://github.com/JBGruber/opinion-wg2/blob/gllm-annotation/paper-annotation/3_wg2_full_paper_annotation.qmd)

You should work in the "gllm-annotation" Github branch for this. You don't have to use my approach or the notebook though (also I much prefer it over Jupyter and you can use it with Python). And if you have a better idea, let me know.

I would prefer that this is done via an open model, like llama3. But if this does not work well enough, I think we should consider OpenAI. Here are some thoughts:

- the data we use is not private in any way. There are published articles. But there are copyright concerns when sending the PDFs to openAI

- reproducibility is also not a grand concern in this specific case. We are doing a literature review, we don't measure some important social phenomenon. It's very unlikely anyone would ever reproduce this with the same data. Rather, people would use the approach for a larger and/or newer review
- we do not have money to pay for API requests. But this is probably not very expensive. I'm happy to donate some of my daily allowance from COST to this end. As long as this doesn't amass a massive bill.

Aleksandar Tomasevic:

- Bruno is working on a pipeline for processing papers with GPT4. Right now, the bottleneck is parsing URLs stored in footnotes which are far away from the reference source in text.
- Once he solves this, we move forward to process ~ 10 papers and estimate the costs before proceeding to test all papers from the test sample.
- Depending on the costs, we need to agree on how to pay and which API key to use.
- We proceed to test all papers and evaluate the performance.
- During this process, we will determine whether this sample is enough or we need to annotate more full papers
- We need to agree on the slot for next Zoom meeting after Salamanca.

**Predicting the relevance of abstracts** <https://github.com/JBGruber/opinion-wg2/pull/21>

- model with a SVM that we actually use
- a (less polished) notebook for exploring the same thing on colab with BERT, which does not seem to be worthwhile to pursue (given the very good recall of the traditional models)

Damian Trilling added 3 commits:

- SML prediction Salamanca Day 1
- also add BERT
- added predictions

Johannes B. Gruber added predictions

**Creating new project, planning tasks 2/3** <https://github.com/JBGruber/opinion-wg2/issues/22>

After completion of the Paper (<https://github.com/users/JBGruber/projects/4>), we need to start working on Tasks 2 and 3, the improvement of existing procedures and tools, and the dissemination. The latter is already partly happening (COPA), and is a logical consequence, so we can focus on Task 2. During the Salamanca meeting, we discussed the overall direction:

- Due to the rapid developments in the area, it seems like a dead-end street to focus on the improvement of existing tools/resources (like sentiment

dictionaries etc). This is not to say that everything is to be solved by LLMs (they may be overkill, are resource-intensive, hard to validate and replicate)

- We will focus on improving procedures, the whole pipeline
- Rough idea: develop a checklist or decision tree(-ish) guideline/paper, focusing on which theoretical and conceptual consideration should translate to which methodological choices.
- In essence, the idea would be to improve existing processes/pipelines (ideally, build on what is identified in the previously mentioned paper as being popular).
- Example: If you are interested in X, rather than doing Y, you should consider Z1 and Z2, with these-and-these arguments for and against
- This should explicitly cover the spectrum from very basic to very advanced approaches, and trying to 'eradicate' ;-) bad approaches from the field, lifting the field to a higher standard

## 7 WG SESSIONS: WG3 DATA & APPLICATION

- Opening of WG3 meetings and short reflection on attendance
- Looking back at previous WG3 achievements and reflection on success of these (e.g. data classification system, survey on available data among OPINION members)
- Chair outlines strategy for the next months to create a first draft of the data inventory. This includes reflection on the METEOR meta data classification and a short introduction to METEOR 2.0 capabilities.
- Common work on the classification system and discussion of potential pitfalls and problems. Establishment of an excel file for coding and word doc with coding instructions in draft version.
- Short discussion of identification of data sets in cooperation with WG2 coding of literature. Exchange with WG2 chair on this matter. Principle agreement to cooperate between WGs.
- Chair introduced idea of report on recommendations for data archiving and meta data standards. Short discussion.
- Agreement on future planning: Completion of coding scheme and entry masks, cooperation with WG2 on data set identification, distribution of coding tasks among WG3 members.



## 8 WG SESSIONS: WG4 INCLUSION & DISSEMINATION

## Session 1

(Sessions 2 & 3 were dedicated to work on projects)

Review Meeting Limassol (Jan 2024)

## Round of Introductions

## Summary of tasks deployed by WG4

## Academic Outputs and Data collection

Work in progress: computational literacy, LLMs as tool for CTAM

## Policy Outputs

New trail this COST meeting

## Maintaining repository (training materials) website

All training materials are on the OPINION website

## Organization of COpA in Salamanca 2024

We're looking forward to it, but many who wanted to cannot join...

Action point Mariken van der Velden: discuss with the core group if we can do some lectures again as online master classes.

Podcast proposal (by Mario Haim)

Mariken suggested coming up with the topics for the podcast, to make an invitation so people can gain traction for their work, the team by Mario still makes the decisions.

Action point Carlos Arcila Calderon: discuss this with Mario

CoPA 2025

Based on the list made in Limassol (Multi-modal analyses; Multi-lingual analyses; How to; create high quality annotated data; Social Network Analyses; Inspiring session on data ethics & legal issues; ABM & simulations; Algorithmic biases; LLMs; Harmful speech; Topic modelling & BERT) we picked a general topic: harmful opinions, with 0.5 day spend (lecture + tutorial) on the following topics:





Workshops on different topics, for example, organizing it as a masterclass, every two months, this person is going to talk about this and that, have a date and make an invitation, should she serve as a coordinator, a Eda and Ana, will serve as organisers and coordinators for the masterclass, interesting topics, name and a title, Mariken suggested to make it as a survey to the network as a list of topics that people would like to give a master class for that.

## 9 CLOSING PLENARY SESSION

*Christian Baden, Chair*

- Each WG reported on the progress made during the meeting (see minutes above)
- Each of the programmed project collaboration spaces reported on the progress made during the meetings
- There will be a Hackathon organized by OPINION adjacent to the ECREA Annual Conference in Ljubljana, to be held on 22-23 September. The Hackathon will be organized by a team under the leadership of Felicia Loecherbach, including (inter alia) Carlos Arcila Calderon, Wouter van Attevelde, Aleksandar Tomasevic, Mariken van der Velden, Serghei Sprincean, Nenad Pantelic, Nelda Kote, Srdjan Vesic, and perhaps some additional people. The theme will focus on opinion research, posing a broad challenge that requires convergent expertise from Social Sciences, IT and linguistics to master. The hackathon is intended to foster new cross-disciplinary collaborations, i.e., it will not be a prize fight among existing teams, but an opportunity to develop new teams and directions. Further details will be announced by the organizing team.  
OPINION Members will be able to receive reimbursement for their participation. If there is additional space, we may open the event to outside participants, too.
- OPINION hosts a special panel to the ECREA European Communication Conference at Ljubljana, 24-27 September, entitled “Advancing the study of opinion expressions in digital media: The OPINION Network approach”.
- The upcoming OPINION meeting in Summer 2025 is intended to take place in Albania, likely at the University of Elbasan, upon invitation by Edlira Gugu. We are soliciting bids to host the upcoming winter meeting in January/February 2025.
- Finally, a huge thanks to the wonderful local organizer team, headed by Carlos Arcila Calderon, for a perfectly organized meeting!

*Group picture of all participants*



| Nr | Participant                                                               | Country | Signature                                                                             | Is Attending |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| 40 | Milojevic, Ana<br>ana.milojevic@ipn.bg.ac.rs                              | RS      |  | Yes          |
| 41 | Mistrean, Larisa<br>mistrean_larisa@yahoo.com                             | MD      |  | Yes          |
| 42 | Mulahmetovic Ibrissimovic, Anela<br>anela.mulahmetovicibrisimovic@untz.ba | BA      |  |              |
| 43 | Negrea Buzatu, Elena<br>elena.negrea@comunicare.ro                        | RO      |  |              |
| 44 | Ozcan, Alper<br>alper.ozcan@gmail.com                                     | TR      |  | Yes          |
| 45 | Palamidova-Sterjadovska, Nikola<br>nikolina@eod.ukim.edu.mk               | MK      |  | Yes          |
| 46 | Pantelic, Nenad<br>npantelic.fn@gmail.com                                 | RS      |  | Yes          |
| 47 | Reci, Ardita<br>arditareci@gmail.com                                      | AL      |  | Yes          |
| 48 | Rosenfeldová, Jana<br>jana.rosenfeldova@fsv.cuni.cz                       | CZ      |  | Yes          |
| 49 | Santana Pereira, José<br>jose.santana.pereira@scte.ult.pt                 | PT      |  | Yes          |
| 50 | Spincean, Serghei<br>spinceanas@yahoo.com                                 | MD      |  | Yes          |
| 51 | Springer, Nina<br>nina.springer@uni-muenster.de                           | DE      |                                                                                       | Yes          |
| 52 | Stepinska, Agnieszka<br>agnieszka.stepinska@amu.edu.pl                    | PL      |  | Yes          |
| 53 | Tomašević, Aleksandar<br>aleksandar.tomasovic@uni-sg.ac.rs                | RS      |  | Yes          |



OPINION | COST Action CA21129

\* Working Group - Working group session DAY 1 (face to face) (Start Date: 11/06/2024 End Date: 11/06/2024)

| Nr | Participant                                            | Country | Signature                                                                         | Is Attending |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| 54 | Trilling, Damian<br>d.c.trilling@vu.nl                 | NL      |  | Yes          |
| 55 | Uman, Aleksandra<br>uman@fki.uzh.ch                    | CH      |  | Yes          |
| 56 | van der Velden, Mariken<br>m.a.c.g.vander.velde@vu.nl  | NL      |  | Yes          |
| 57 | Veselićević, Selma<br>selma.veselicevic@urtz.ba        | BA      |  |              |
| 58 | Vesic, Srdjan<br>vesic@cril.fr                         | FR      |  | Yes          |
| 59 | Vochocová, Lenka<br>lenka.vochocova@fsv.cuni.cz        | CZ      |  | Yes          |
| 60 | Vukovic, Vuk<br>vuk.vukovic.hn@gmail.com               | ME      |  |              |
| 61 | YUN, Bruno<br>bruno.yun@abdn.ac.uk                     | FR      |  | Yes          |
| 62 | Okazki, Nunan<br>nunan.okazki@yeditepe.edu.tr          | TR      |  | Yes          |
| 63 | Ozmen, Güle Yüksel<br>ozmen.guleyuksemen@yildiz.azs.tr | TR      |  | Yes          |

Country Codes: Albania (AL), Austria (AT), Belgium (BE), Bosnia and Herzegovina (BA), Bulgaria (BG), Croatia (HR), Cyprus (CY), Czech Republic (CZ), Denmark (DK), Estonia (EE), Finland (FI), France (FR), Germany (DE), Greece (EL), Hungary (HU), Iceland (IS), Ireland (IE), Israel (IL), Italy (IT), Latvia (LV), Lithuania (LT), Luxembourg (LU), Malta (MT), Montenegro (ME), The Netherlands (NL), the North Republic of Macedonia (MK), Norway (NO), Poland (PL), Portugal (PT), The Republic of Moldova (MD), Romania (RO), Serbia (RS), Slovakia (SK), Slovenia (SI), Spain (ES), Sweden (SE), Switzerland (CH), Turkey (TR), United Kingdom (UK).

**Wednesday, 12 June 2024**



This information is collected for the purpose of checking eligibility for reimbursement of your expenses under the COST Annotated-Rules-for-COST-Actions-Level-C and, when the meeting takes place in COST premises, for safety purposes in compliance with our legal obligations under Belgian law. It will be kept for the duration of COST audit obligations as mentioned in the privacy notice for e-COST. It won't be transferred to any third party except in case of use for safety purposes where it will be transferred to the landlord of the premises and emergency services.

## MEETING ATTENDANCE LIST OF ( JOINT WG MEETING II.2 SALAMANCA - 12/06/2024 )

The attendance list provides the names of the participants who confirmed attendance via their personal e-COST invitation link.

Meeting Title: Joint WG Meeting II.2 Salamanca

Meeting Reference: E-COST-MEETING-CA21129-110624-e9516934

Action Number: CA21129

Meeting Administrator: Aysen Simsek

E-mail: a.simsek@vu.nl

- Working Group - Working group session DAY 2 (face to face) (Start Date: 12/06/2024 End Date: 12/06/2024)
- Management Committee - Management Committee Meeting (hybrid) (Start Date: 12/06/2024 End Date: 12/06/2024)

| Nr | Participant                                         | Country | Signature                                                                           | Is Attending |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| 1  | Adamczewska, Kinga<br>kinga.adamczewska@amu.edu.pl  | PL      |  | Yes          |
| 2  | Arcila Calderón, Carlos<br>carlosa@usal.es          | ES      |  | Yes          |
| 3  | Baczkowska, Anna<br>anna.baczkowska@ug.edu.pl       | PL      |  | Yes          |
| 4  | Baden, Christian<br>c.baden@mail.huji.ac.il         | IL      |  | Yes          |
| 5  | Bajceta, Snezana<br>snezana.bajceta@gmail.com       | RS      |  |              |
| 6  | Bieleńa, Małgorzata<br>malgorzata.bieleńa@ug.edu.pl | PL      |  | Yes          |
| 7  | Bieleńa Grajewska, Magdalena<br>angmb@univ.gda.pl   | PL      |  | Yes          |
| 8  | Blanco-Hernero, David<br>d.blancohernero@uva.nl     | NL      |  | Yes          |
| 9  | Bojic, Ljiljana<br>ljiljasa.bojic@gmail.com         | RS      |  | Yes          |
| 10 | Boongarden, Hajo<br>hajo.boongarden@univie.ac.at    | AT      |                                                                                     |              |

- Working Group - Working group session DAY 2 (face to face) (Start Date: 12/06/2024 End Date: 12/06/2024)
- Management Committee - Management Committee Meeting (hybrid) (Start Date: 12/06/2024 End Date: 12/06/2024)

| Nr | Participant                                       | Country | Signature                                                                             | Is Attending |
|----|---------------------------------------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| 11 | CORBU, NICOLETA<br>nicoleta.corbu@comunicare.ro   | RO      |  | Yes          |
| 12 | Clunova-Shuleska, Anita<br>anika@ecoc.ukim.edu.mk | MK      |  | Yes          |
| 13 | Costa, Bruno Daniel Ferreira<br>bdco@ubi.pt       | PT      |  | Yes          |
| 14 | De Liddo, Anna<br>anna.deliddo@open.ac.uk         | UK      |  |              |
| 15 | Dolinsky, Alona<br>a.o.dolinsky@vu.nl             | NL      |  | Yes          |
| 16 | Domahidi, Emese<br>emese.domahidi@tu-berlin.de    | DE      |  | Yes          |
| 17 | Eriksen, Cengiz<br>cengiz.erisen@gmail.com        | TR      |                                                                                       | Yes          |
| 18 | GUGU, Edira<br>egugu6@gmail.com                   | AL      |  | Yes          |
| 19 | Giedici, Jelena<br>jelena.giedici@gmail.com       | RS      |  | Yes          |
| 20 | Gloc, Roksana<br>roksana.gloc@uj.edu.pl           | PL      |  | Yes          |
| 21 | Gruber, Johannes B.<br>johannesb.gruber@gmail.com | NL      |  | Yes          |
| 22 | Guy, Dana<br>dana.guy@ucdconnect.ie               | IE      |  | Yes          |
| 23 | Hase, Valerie<br>valerie.hase@ifix.lmu.de         | DE      |  | Yes          |
| 24 | Haveriku, Alba<br>alba.haveriku@tu.edu.al         | AL      |  | Yes          |

OPINION | COST Action CA21129

- Working Group - Working group session DAY 2 (face to face) (Start Date: 12/06/2024 End Date: 12/06/2024)
- Management Committee - Management Committee Meeting (hybrid) (Start Date: 12/06/2024 End Date: 12/06/2024)

| Nr | Participant                                                                 | Country | Signature     | Is Attending |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|---------------|--------------|
| 25 | Hess, Agnieszka<br>agnieszka.hess@uj.edu.pl                                 | PL      | A. Hess       | Yes          |
| 26 | ilić, Mirjana<br>mirjana.ilić@fifak.rs.ac.rs                                | RS      |               |              |
| 27 | Jerjele, Tonja<br>Tonja.Jerjele@fiv.uni-ij.si                               | SI      |               | Yes          |
| 28 | Jovanović, Ana<br>ana.jovanovic@fifak.rs.ac.rs                              | IE      | Ana Jovanovic | Yes          |
| 29 | Kazarić, Ledić<br>lediacarzin@gmail.com                                     | AL      | Ledić         | Yes          |
| 30 | Kole, Nelda<br>nikole@fs.edu.ai                                             | AL      | Nelda         | Yes          |
| 31 | Kristo, Ema<br>ema_kristo@yahoo.co.uk                                       |         | E. Kristo     | Yes          |
| 32 | Krnić, Aleksandra<br>aleksandrass@yahoo.com                                 | RS      | Aleksandra    | Yes          |
| 33 | Kunić, Tamara<br>tkunic@fhs.unizg.hr                                        | HR      | Kunić         | Yes          |
| 34 | Langer, Ana<br>ana.langer@glasgow.ac.uk                                     | UK      |               | Yes          |
| 35 | Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, Barbara<br>barbara.lewandowska.tomaszczyk@gmail.com | PL      | Barbara       | Yes          |
| 36 | Lipiński, Artur<br>artip@amu.edu.pl                                         | PL      | Artur         | Yes          |
| 37 | Maier, Michaela<br>michaela.maier@rptu.de                                   | DE      | Maier         | Yes          |
| 38 | Mazák, Jaromír<br>jaromir.mazak@stem.cz                                     | CZ      | Mazák         | Yes          |

- Working Group - Working group session DAY 2 (face to face) (Start Date: 12/06/2024 End Date: 12/06/2024)
- Management Committee - Management Committee Meeting (hybrid) (Start Date: 12/06/2024 End Date: 12/06/2024)

| Nr | Participant                                             | Country | Signature                                                                           | Is Attending |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| 53 | Tomašević, Aleksandar<br>atomaševic@ums.ac.rs           | RS      |    | Yes          |
| 54 | Trilling, Damian<br>d.c.trilling@vu.nl                  | NL      |  | Yes          |
| 55 | Uman, Aleksandra<br>uman@fz.uzh.ch                      | CH      |  | Yes          |
| 56 | van der Velden, Mariëtte<br>m.a.c.g.vander.velden@vu.nl | NL      |  | Yes          |
| 57 | Veselić Jerković, Selma<br>selma.veselić@untz.ba        | BA      |  | Yes          |
| 58 | Vesic, Srdjan<br>vesic@orli.fr                          | FR      |  | Yes          |
| 59 | Vochocová, Lenka<br>lenka.vochocova@fsv.cuni.cz         | CZ      |  | Yes          |
| 60 | Vuković, Vuk<br>vuk.vukovic@e@gmail.com                 | ME      |  |              |
| 61 | YUN, Bruno<br>bruno.yun@abdn.ac.uk                      | FR      |  | Yes          |
| 62 | Öksüz, Nuran<br>nuran.oksuz@yeditepe.edu.tr             | TR      |  | Yes          |
| 63 | Özmen, Süle Yüksel<br>sycumen@trabzon.edu.tr            | TR      |  | Yes          |

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- **Working Group - Working group session DAY 2 (face to face)** (Start Date: 12/06/2024 End Date: 12/06/2024)
- **Management Committee - Management Committee Meeting (hybrid)** (Start Date: 12/06/2024 End Date: 12/06/2024)

|    | Participant                                                            | Country | Signature                                                                           | Is Attending |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| 39 | Miloni, Doinita<br>doina.miloni@gmail.com                              | CY      |  | Yes          |
| 40 | Milosevic, Ana<br>ana.milosevic@fjfn.bg.ac.rs                          | RS      |  | Yes          |
| 41 | Mistrean, Larisa<br>mistrean_larisa@yahoo.com                          | MD      |  | Yes          |
| 42 | Mulahmetović Ibrilimović, Aneta<br>aneta.mulahmetovic@isimovic.untz.ba | BA      |  | Yes          |
| 43 | Negrea Busuico, Elena<br>elena.negrea@comunicare.ro                    | RO      |  | Yes          |
| 44 | Ozcan, Alper<br>alper.ozcan@gmail.com                                  | TR      |  | Yes          |
| 45 | Palamidova-Sterjadovska, Nikolaia<br>nikolina@ecfc.ukim.edu.mk         | MK      |  | Yes          |
| 46 | Pantelić, Nenad<br>npantelic.fn@gmail.com                              | RS      |  | Yes          |
| 47 | Regi, Ardita<br>arditareci@gmail.com                                   | AL      |  | Yes          |
| 48 | Rosenfeldová, Jana<br>jana.rosenfeldova@fsv.cuni.cz                    | CZ      |  | Yes          |
| 49 | Santana Pereira, José<br>jose.santana.pereira@scte-ufc.pt              | PT      |  | Yes          |
| 50 | Spriocean, Serghel<br>spriocean@yahoo.com                              | MD      |  | Yes          |
| 51 | Springer, Nina<br>nina.springer@uni-muenster.de                        | DE      |  | Yes          |
| 52 | Stepinska, Agnieszka<br>agnieszka.stepinska@amu.edu.pl                 | PL      |  | Yes          |